Prahlin Portfolio Work Log - October 15, 2026 (Part 2)

Compiled summary for Thursday, October 15, 2026 - Part 2 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio after the earlier October 15 Core Beliefs and Productivity Hacks record; independently re-verifying the United States Eastern date; refreshing the repository snapshot; extracting and studying the complete pre-existing PDF worklog archive; expanding Featured Case Studies to five cards; assigning the established purple, orange, blue, yellow, and green families to those cards; refining platform and device metadata cells; protecting the one-card portrait composition; carrying the five-color system into the UI / UX Philosophy carousel; stabilizing inactive-stack geometry and asset presentation; replacing project imagery and device frames; revising philosophy copy; enlarging selected typography and media; preventing clipped card content; preserving project-label and no-wrap behavior; recovering repeatedly stale Turbopack stylesheets; validating type safety, routes, carousel geometry, computed colors, internal clearances, and repository state; documenting commit 506edff; and generating the second October 15 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahlin Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening synthesis, source-material review, prior baseline, goals, grouped work-completed sections, committed-source chronology, validation, files and artifacts, follow-up context, and an output-artifact close. This record emphasizes the final accepted implementation while retaining enough iteration history to explain the protected geometry and visual decisions.

Coverage begins after portfolio_worklog_october15.pdf and documentation commit 68fb2c8. The application work is represented by commit 506edff3b7cd33895c8d74fc87e7e6cbf21012a3 on main, which matches origin/main. No GitHub Actions dispatch, Hostinger synchronization, deploy-branch mutation, or production release was performed during this documentation pass. Before PDF creation, the only uncommitted delta was the customary reader-refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Date verification: an independent UTC-04:00 time lookup returned October 15, 2026 at 10:29:59 PM. A local TZ=America/New_York verification at 10:31:32 PM returned Thursday, October 15, 2026, EDT, with the -0400 offset. October 15 remains within United States Eastern Daylight Time, so the title and filename use October 15 rather than UTC or the execution host default.
- Project reader: ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio. It refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt with the current tree, source, asset inventory, configuration, Git history, PDF inventory, and standing workflow instructions.
- Worklog archive: enumerated and extracted all 54 pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDF worklogs, spanning July 11 through the first October 15 record. The archive contains 307 pages and approximately 155,075 extracted words, including the established same-day Part suffix convention.
- Archive comparison: compared filename cadence, title construction, opening-summary density, recurring section order, implementation-bullet voice, validation language, file inventories, follow-up continuity, footer placement, pagination, and metadata across the full archive. Used October 15 Part 1 as the direct chronological baseline and October 13, October 9, October 8, October 7, and September 29 Part 2 as the nearest structural references.
- PDF convention: confirmed US Letter portrait at 612 x 792 points, PDF 1.4, no encryption, black text on white, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold Type 1 fonts, a dated first-page title, 42-point side margins, compact technical prose, repeated footer title, right-aligned page numbers, and Codex author, creator, and producer metadata.
- Git evidence: inspected the full commit body, file statistics, and final source for 506edff. The commit changed six tracked files with 474 insertions and 62 deletions, including five application files and the reader-generated project snapshot.
- Runtime evidence: reviewed the live landing page at http://127.0.0.1:3000, browser screenshots for all relevant carousel states, computed styles, DOM geometry, project routes, TypeScript results, and the accepted responsive behavior recorded during implementation.

Baseline Status Before October 15 Part 2

- Featured Case Studies contained four cards and did not yet provide a fifth reserved project slot. The cards used a shared dark treatment rather than one designated family per card.
- Platform and device metadata used narrow divider-based rows whose labels and sibling cells did not yet provide the requested boxed, balanced, two-stack presentation.
- Portrait layouts were sensitive to grid changes. Any case-card expansion needed to preserve the established rule that narrow and portrait modes show one card per row.
- The UI / UX Philosophy carousel had five visible color identities through its key and typography, but its number box, heading box, and large content box did not yet inherit matching card surfaces and borders.
- Inactive desktop stacks used separate narrower internal layouts. Their screenshots and copy therefore changed apparent size and alignment as stacks moved away from the horizontal center.
- The orange philosophy treatment mixed poorly with colored surface experiments. It needed a neutral supporting surface while retaining orange hierarchy in the key, border, and typography.
- Philosophy copy, media assignments, and large-box typography still reflected the earlier project mapping. Several user-directed wording, scaling, ordering, and clipping safeguards had not yet been applied.

Goals for October 15 Part 2

- Add a fifth placeholder case-study card without polluting the repeated Articles card seeds, and keep the placeholder easy to replace with final project content.
- Give each featured card one established color family, restrained sheen, dark surface, matching borders, and coordinated metadata accents without allowing the five colors to mix against the green page background.
- Rework the platform and device rows into boxed cells with clear hierarchy, aligned widths, controlled gaps, and placeholder support while preserving one-card portrait layouts.

- Apply the same five designated families to the five philosophy stacks, covering the number box, heading box, large content box, typography, border, and background numeral while leaving the navigation triangles unchanged.
- Make inactive carousel stacks reuse the active internal layout so screenshots, text, and device frames retain identical proportions at every rotational position.
- Preserve the accepted outer carousel silhouette by recalibrating stack offsets and horizontal scale after canonicalizing internal widths.
- Reassign project media and device frames, refine the orange stack, revise copy, enlarge selected text and imagery, and protect all large-box content from edge clipping.
- Keep the local preview available, clear stale caches when source and rendered CSS diverge, validate the final implementation, and document the synchronized commit without performing a deployment.

Work Completed - Five Featured Case Studies

- Added a typed CaseStudyTone model and assigned one family to each landing card: Cinerific purple, Alla Vostra orange, Credit King blue, Future Case Study yellow, and Prahl.dev green.
- Added Future Case Study as a fifth placeholder with reserved eyebrow, description, tags, commit and worklog statistics, and explicit TBD platform and device labels.
- Kept the placeholder out of articleCaseStudySeeds so the Articles repetition system continues to use only real case studies rather than cloning unfinished placeholder content.
- Reordered the final pair so the yellow placeholder precedes the green Prahl.dev card while retaining each card's designated color identity.
- Added data-case-tone attributes to linked and unlinked card shells, allowing the visual system to remain data-driven instead of relying on positional selectors.
- Built subtle radial and diagonal sheens over a dark rgba(3, 7, 5, 0.67) foundation, with family-specific core, middle, and edge values and restrained mixed-color borders and inset light.
- Coordinated eyebrow, worklog statistic, platform heading, platform slot, divider, and topline accent colors with each card's owning family.
- Added an explicit portrait rule through 1040 pixels so the featured grid remains one card per row in narrow portrait modes.

Work Completed - Platform and Device Metadata Cells

- Extended ProjectDeviceStack with optional platformLabels in parallel with the existing deviceLabels override, enabling the placeholder card to display TBD without inventing Android, iOS, web, phone, or tablet support.
- Added the custom platform-label sequence to the measurement-effect dependency key so responsive spacing recalculates when authored labels change.
- Reworked the metadata grid from a one-pixel divider column into a fixed 92-pixel heading column, a flexible breathing column, and content-sized sibling cells.
- Converted PLATFORM and DEVICE headings into bordered, rounded cells with controlled padding, line height, and equal fixed width.
- Converted each sibling label into its own bordered, rounded 54-pixel cell with a shared minimum height and inherited family color.
- Removed the old visible inter-cell and inter-row divider elements after the cells themselves became fully encapsulated from every direction.
- Tightened sibling-cell gaps, increased vertical separation between metadata rows, and preserved right-side sibling grouping without forcing the stacks against the card margins.
- Preserved the project-title rendering path for variants and fallbacks, including the existing title underline treatment and semantic heading label.

Work Completed - Five-Color Philosophy Surfaces

- Added a UIUX_DECISION_CASE_TONES mapping for decisions 01 through 05 in purple, yellow, blue, orange, and green order.
- Attached data-case-tone and data-decision-number attributes to each 3D stack so color, typography, media scaling, and layout exceptions remain declarative.
- Applied coordinated dark surfaces, borders, subtle radial blooms, diagonal sheen, and inset light to each stack's number box, title bridge, and large content box.
- Retained the existing navigation-triangle treatment instead of recoloring it, preserving the established control language while the boxes carry the new family identity.
- Reduced yellow and orange surface bloom to keep the warm families from appearing muddy or overly similar. Yellow retained a restrained charcoal foundation and low-opacity diagonal sheen.
- Rebuilt orange around the neutral #0d1210 surface, removed orange surface sheen and inset glow, and retained orange only in its key, title hierarchy, typography, and 25-percent border.
- Preserved the accepted orange key gradient from yellow through dark orange while preventing the large boxes from drifting toward purple or red under the dark page treatment.
- Colored the giant faded background numerals with their own designated family core and retained the vertical fade mask at 16-percent opacity.

Work Completed - Carousel Geometry and Asset Consistency

- Replaced the active-versus-inactive internal width split with one canonical 654.4125-pixel stack width for every desktop position.
- Made every stack use the primary internal layout so text, screenshots, device frames, and project labels retain the same proportions before and after moving away from center.
- Introduced named geometry constants for the canonical width, adjacent offset, adjacent horizontal scale, outer offset, and outer horizontal scale.
- Calibrated adjacent stacks to an offset of 645.2431 and scaleX of 0.6664507, and outer stacks to an offset of 932.1406 and scaleX of 0.0977649.
- Restored the previous visible bounding boxes after canonicalizing the internal layout. Browser measurements showed the active stack at approximately 583.08 by 813.62 pixels while the side silhouettes retained their accepted placement.
- Reduced the side-copy scale from 0.51 to 0.5 so the unified internal layout did not subtly enlarge text when a stack left center.

- Repeated forward and reverse carousel cycles with reduced motion and confirmed stable positions, unchanged outer geometry, and no accumulated horizontal-flip or clipping errors.

Work Completed - Philosophy Media, Copy, and Hierarchy

- Reassigned decision 01 to the Cinerific landscape tablet image, tablet frame, Cinerific project label, and /projects/cinerific destination.
- Reassigned decision 05 to the Alla Vostra startup image, Android phone frame, AI Generative annotation, Alla Vostra project label, and /projects/alla-vostra destination.
- Replaced decision 04's earlier Cinerific tablet with the Alla Vostra tutorial step-four screenshot in the Android device frame and linked it to the Alla Vostra project page.
- Moved PROJECT: CINERIFIC above the decision 01 tablet while leaving other project labels in their established positions.
- Revised decision 01 to Sleek, Streamlined, NEVER, and Dated; revised decision 02 to Interwoven, Interconnected, ALWAYS, and Congruent.
- Revised decision 05 to Adaptable In Form Factor, Scalable In Device Type, NEVER, and Cookie Cutter, and locked its first two lines against wrapping.
- Removed trailing periods from all oversized underlined emphasis words while preserving punctuation on their supporting lines.
- Matched decision 02 and decision 04 large-box copy scale to decision 01 through a 0.6875 internal transform and compensated content width.
- Enlarged decision 01's tablet treatment by 25 percent from its original internal size and moved it downward to separate it from the enlarged copy.
- Increased decision 01 NEVER and decision 02 ALWAYS twice by five percent, ending at the same 137.8125-pixel source size.

Work Completed - Protected Margins and No-Clipping Rules

- Added data-decision-number to the full stack in addition to the focused card, allowing stack-specific scaling and placement rules to follow a decision through every carousel role.
- Added --uiux-focused-safe-inline as the shared large-card inset and rewired description-span width and negative-margin compensation around that token.
- Corrected decision 01's transformed text width after the 25-percent enlargement. The accepted geometry restored approximately 17.82 pixels of visible left and right padding rather than allowing the text container to extend 44 pixels past both edges.
- Added explicit overflow-visible and clip-path-none safeguards to active-card, focused-card, copy, device-slot, and frame-stack layers. The device screen itself still clips its screenshot inside the physical bezel as intended.
- Separated the decision 01 text and device transform rules so moving the image could not accidentally move the copy through a grouped selector.
- Lowered decision 01's device slot to 330 pixels after enlarging its copy, preserving an approximately eight-pixel copy-to-asset gap, 32 pixels of right clearance, and more than 31 pixels of bottom clearance.
- Compensated the enlarged decision 01, 02, and 04 text containers to keep the same approximately 18-pixel visible side padding used by the original accepted boxes.
- Used actual browser Range glyph rectangles, not only containing spans, to confirm that the enlarged decision 02 and 04 copy did not collide with their phone frames.

Work Completed - Local Cache Recovery and Iterative Verification

- Kept the Next.js development preview running at http://127.0.0.1:3000 throughout the landing-page work.
- Detected repeated cases where Turbopack served old CSS after the DOM and source had already changed. Computed transforms, white-space values, and new selectors were compared directly against source before any compensating edits were accepted.
- Stopped the development server, moved stale .next output into timestamped ignored .next.cleared-* archives, and restarted from a clean cache whenever normal hot reload did not expose the authored stylesheet.
- Used browser screenshots and computed rectangles after each sensitive carousel adjustment, particularly the unified side-stack geometry, decision 01 scaling, project-label ordering, no-wrap behavior, and designated background-number colors.
- Verified all five faded numeral bases individually: purple rgb(221, 75, 253), yellow rgb(255, 209, 2), blue rgb(1, 171, 253), orange rgb(237, 93, 7), and green rgb(51, 241, 80), each at 0.16 opacity.
- Confirmed the final decision 01 image and label remained within the large box after moving the label above the tablet, with more than 31 pixels of bottom clearance.

Committed Source Sequence

- 506edff - Refined landing case studies and UI/UX philosophy carousel. Added the fifth placeholder case study and five card tones; rebuilt platform and device cells; carried the color system into the five carousel stacks; standardized geometry; remapped screenshots, frames, labels, and links; revised philosophy copy; enlarged selected typography and imagery; and added protected-margin and no-clipping rules.
- The commit changed app/PortfolioSections.tsx, app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx, app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx, app/globals.css, app/page.tsx, and portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt with 474 insertions and 62 deletions.
- At documentation time, HEAD, main, origin/main, and origin/HEAD all resolve to 506edff3b7cd33895c8d74fc87e7e6cbf21012a3. The application work is committed and synchronized; this documentation pass has not created a commit, push, deployment, or external release.

Validation Summary

- npm run check completed successfully against the current source.
- git diff --check -- app completed without whitespace errors.
- The locally served routes /, /projects/alla-vostra, /projects/cinerific, /aboutdev, and /articles each returned HTTP 200 during the documentation pass.
- Browser inspection confirmed the active carousel stack remains approximately 583.08 by 813.62 pixels after internal-layout unification.
- Five-step forward and reverse carousel checks preserved the accepted side-stack bounding boxes and internal asset proportions.

- Decision 01's enlarged text retained approximately 17.82 pixels of visible left and right padding; its tablet and label retained approximately 32 pixels of right and bottom clearance.
- Decision 02 and decision 04 resolved to the same 0.6875 copy transform as decision 01, and Range-based glyph checks reported no intersections with their phone frames.
- Decision 05's first two lines resolved to white-space nowrap and rendered as single lines inside the large box.
- NEVER and ALWAYS resolved to the same 137.813-pixel computed source size after the final paired increase.
- Each giant numeral inherited its own stack's designated accent and retained the common 16-percent fade treatment.
- Portrait case-study CSS retained one grid column through the protected 1040-pixel portrait range.
- Repository status before PDF creation showed only portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt modified by the customary project-reader refresh.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/PortfolioSections.tsx - fifth placeholder case-study data, typed color families, placeholder platform and device labels, article-seed exclusion, title fallback structure, and data-case-tone attributes.
- app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx - custom platform-label support, recalculation dependency, and revised platform/device metadata grid sizing.
- app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx - five case-tone mapping, canonical desktop stack constants, unified primary internal layout, recalibrated stack offsets and scales, and decision/tone data attributes.
- app/globals.css - featured-card palettes and sheens, metadata cells, portrait one-column protection, five philosophy surface systems, orange neutral treatment, unified stack scaling, safe-area rules, typography and media adjustments, no-wrap behavior, project-label ordering, and faded accent numerals.
- app/page.tsx - final philosophy copy plus Cinerific and Alla Vostra media, frame, label, and route assignments.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - refreshed project-reader output generated after the synchronized application commit.
- portfolio_worklog_october15_part2.pdf - new customary second worklog generated by this documentation pass.

Follow-Up Notes

- Replace Future Case Study placeholder content when a real fifth project is ready. Keep it excluded from articleCaseStudySeeds until the project has a real route and complete editorial content.
- Preserve the card-to-family mapping unless later project semantics explicitly require a change: Cinerific purple, Alla Vostra orange, Credit King blue, placeholder yellow, and Prahl.dev green.
- Keep portrait featured cards at one column. The max-width 1040 portrait rule exists because a two-card row was specifically rejected in narrow orientation.
- Preserve the canonical stack width and calibrated offset/scale constants as one geometry system. Changing only internal width or only side offsets can reintroduce inconsistent screenshot sizing.
- Keep orange on the neutral #0d1210 surface unless a later approved treatment replaces the whole warm-stack hierarchy. Earlier colored bases repeatedly mixed toward purple or muddy brown.
- Do not remove the focused-card safe-area compensation when changing copy scale. Transformed copy uses width compensation to preserve the visible 18-pixel inset.
- Move media vertically when copy grows rather than clipping card edges. Keep browser-measured right and bottom clearances positive and preserve explicit overflow safeguards.
- Keep decision 05's first two authored lines nowrap unless their copy changes enough to require a new responsive rule.
- If source changes fail to appear locally, inspect computed CSS and clear or move .next before adjusting correct source to compensate for a stale bundle.
- Before committing or pushing this documentation pass, review the refreshed snapshot and Part 2 PDF together and use a past-tense documentation commit message distinct from 506edff.

Output Artifact

- Generated /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_october15_part2.pdf using the established lowercase-month, non-zero-padded-day, same-day Part suffix convention.
- The artifact uses US Letter portrait pages, PDF 1.4, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold, compact black-on-white technical prose, repeated dated Part 2 footers, right-aligned page numbers, and Codex metadata consistent with the mature archive.
- The recorded application baseline is 506edff3b7cd33895c8d74fc87e7e6cbf21012a3 on synchronized main and origin/main. No application source was edited while creating this record.
- Documentation deltas created by this pass are the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt and portfolio_worklog_october15_part2.pdf. No deployment, remote message, branch mutation, or production publish was performed.